

SOUTH SUDAN – NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

January 2026 – February 2026 Analysis

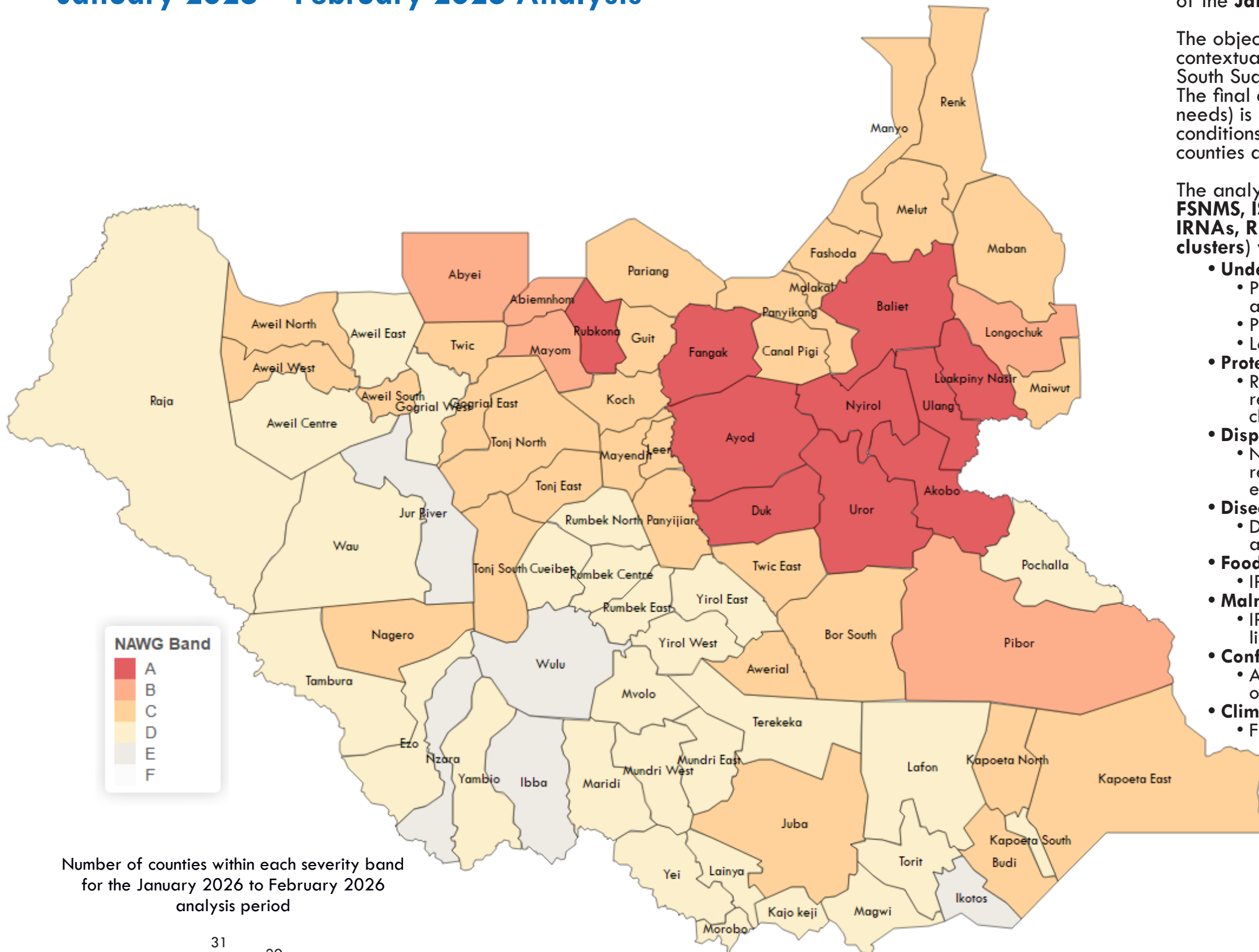
Background

The NAWG meeting was held on March 17, 2026 to discuss the analysis of the **January 2026 to February 2026** period.

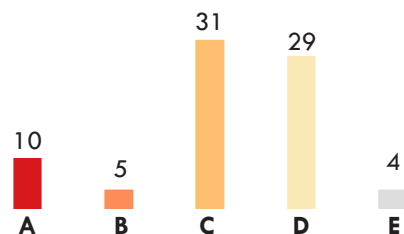
The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of critical life-saving humanitarian needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization by the ICCG. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The analysis encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, ACLED, INSO, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, and data from clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Underlying vulnerability**
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
- **Displacement**
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as significant numbers of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used as a proxy for life-threatening acute malnutrition and excess mortality risk.
- **Conflict**
 - Armed conflict events, conflict-related sexual violence, forced recruitment of children, targeted killings of civilians, targeted property destruction
- **Climate shocks**
 - Flood-related displacement, flood extent, drought stress, rain anomalies.



Number of counties within each severity band for the January 2026 to February 2026 analysis period



For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Kumudu Sanjeewa (sanjeewa@un.org) or Mary Langan (mary.langan@impact-initiatives.org).

Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B	7 - 7.9	Very severe humanitarian conditions
C	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions
D	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
E	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
F	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

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The January - February 2026 NAWG analysis shows that 10 counties remained in Band A (Extreme humanitarian conditions) for the second consecutive cycle. **IOM DTM tracked 317,345 displaced individuals nationally during January - February 2026**, with displacement concentrated in the conflict-affected counties of Jonglei and Upper Nile. The humanitarian situation in Akobo deteriorated sharply in early March when government forces ordered the closure of the UNMISS Temporary Operating Base and issued an evacuation directive for humanitarian workers and all civilians, rendering humanitarian response inside the county not feasible.

[FEWS NET](#) estimates that up to **8.0-8.99 million people will need humanitarian food assistance to prevent widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and worse outcomes through September 2026**, with needs peaking from July to September. **Furthermore, There is a credible risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) in Nasir and Ulang (Upper Nile) and in Ayod, Duk, Nyirol, Uror, Akobo, and Fangak (Jonglei).** Levels of hunger and acute malnutrition are already high, with levels of acute malnutrition expected to surpass the “Extremely Critical” threshold by July in some counties, particularly as cholera incidence surges during the rainy season. If conflict escalates and isolates populations, preventing movement and access to local food sources and humanitarian assistance for a prolonged period, then Famine (IPC Phase 5) would likely occur in these counties. The period of greatest concern is the upcoming lean and flooding seasons (June - September).

Counties Facing “Extreme” Humanitarian Conditions

10 counties were classified as having **extreme humanitarian needs (Band A)** during this analysis period. These counties are **Ulang, Nasir, Rubkona, Fangak, Duk, Baliet, Uror, Nyirol, Akobo, and Ayod.**

Most of these counties are located in [Jonglei and Upper Nile](#) and are facing compounded challenges, including ongoing conflict, high protection risks, significant population displacement, and severe disease burdens.

Discussion and Joint Analysis

- **Ayod:** On 26 February, government-aligned soldiers reportedly gathered civilians under the pretext of food distribution and opened fire, killing at least 25 people including women and children. An estimated 23,180 people were displaced. A cholera outbreak reached 149 cumulative cases with 19 deaths. Government forces seized assets from an INGO compound on 21 January, prompting staff to flee. 2 of 18 health facilities have been destroyed. **Final classification: Elevated to Band A.**

- **Uror:** Uror remained the epicentre of the conflict escalation, with 90 fatalities recorded—the second-highest nationally—including airstrikes in Tiam, Pathai, and Yuai payams. An estimated 88,666 people were displaced—the highest of any county. Displacement sites were identified in Yuai, Pathai, Motot, and Pieri, with destroyed homes reported. The closure of 24 nutrition sites across Uror and Nyirol continues to cut off 7,868 children from care, including 2,633 with severe acute malnutrition. Cholera resurgence was reported. An inter-agency response is ongoing in five villages. **Final classification: Elevated to Band A.**
- **Nyirol:** Nyirol suffered devastating destruction of health infrastructure, with 13 of 16 health facilities destroyed or non-functional. Airstrikes on 3 and 6 February struck a health facility and killed 6 individuals respectively. An estimated 55,640 people were displaced—the second highest nationally. 26 humanitarian personnel remain unaccounted for across Nyirol and Uror. Humanitarian assets were looted and an NGO compound was evacuated and subsequently looted. Widespread conflict-related sexual violence, child recruitment by armed actors, and very limited access to clinical management of rape were reported. **Final classification: Elevated to Band A.**
- **Akobo:** The situation in Akobo deteriorated sharply in early March. On 6 March, government forces ordered the closure of the UNMISS Temporary Operating Base and issued an evacuation directive for humanitarian workers and all civilians. Shelling of Akobo Town is ongoing, markets are non-functional, the county hospital has been looted, and the mobile network has been cut off. An estimated 17,255 people were displaced, with an unverified surge of over 130,000 and a mass exodus since 6 March toward Ethiopia and Upper Nile. 13 of 25 health facilities have suspended services. Humanitarian response inside Akobo was assessed as not feasible as of 9 March. **Final classification: Elevated to Band A.**
- **Longochuk:** On 21 January, opposition forces overran a government base in Pachime village, Dajo Payam, killing 16 soldiers. Sustained clashes continued in Udier and surrounding areas in February, with reports of incendiary weapons and significant casualties. A health facility was looted. Control of Dajo strengthens opposition territorial depth in eastern Upper Nile. From a comparative standpoint, severity is likely lower than in the northern and central Jonglei counties. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**
- **Terekeka:** 27 fatalities and an estimated 9,677 displaced individuals were recorded following an intra-Mundari clash which destroyed Kogi Village. Some displaced populations have since returned. **Final classification: Maintained in Band D, added to close monitoring.**

- **Abiemnhom:** On 1 March, an armed attack by a coalition of armed youth/militia killed approximately 180 people (a mass grave of 162 was confirmed), with 81 injured—one of the deadliest single incidents of the reporting period. Women and children were among the casualties. Over 20,000 people were reportedly displaced. Markets were burned. A rapid assessment on 6 March identified urgent needs across all sectors. The situation remains fluid, with displaced populations also moving into Abyei and Twic. **Final classification: Elevated to Band B.**
- **Abyei:** UNISFA completed the withdrawal of all peacekeepers and national monitors from its team sites in Tishwin and Abu Qussa/Wunkur after security conditions deteriorated. The withdrawal raises concerns about civilian protection. Abyei is also receiving displaced populations from Abiemnhom, with an estimated 2,000–4,000 households arriving. **Final classification: Elevated to Band B.**
- **Kapoeta East:** Armed clashes between government and opposition forces in Narus Town and Lokobuo Village in January caused civilian casualties and displacement, with thousands fleeing into nearby bushland. 2,089 people were reportedly displaced. Reports of returnees from Kakuma indicate significant numbers of arrivals in Kapoeta East and Kapoeta South. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**
- **Yambio:** 5 armed clashes were recorded in February—the highest in the region—including hit-and-run attacks on a checkpoint and a refugee camp outpost. Opposition forces have been resupplying and reorganising, and attacks are assessed as very likely to spread in Western Equatoria prior to the rainy season in April. **Final classification: Maintained in Band D.**
- **Tambura:** More than 5,000 refugees and returnees reportedly arrived from the Central African Republic at the end of January, following election-related tensions and armed clashes. Displaced individuals are sheltering within host communities in the absence of transit or reception facilities. **Final classification: Maintained in Band D.**
- **Nagero:** Nagero was not accessible for much of the past year. Widespread looting and displacement were reported. Efforts are underway to obtain more information from local partners. **Final classification: Maintained in Band D.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties are flagged for close monitoring: **Duk, Fangak, Baliet, Ulang, and Nasir** due to credible famine risk, catastrophic food security and nutrition conditions, cholera/WASH concerns, and conflict-related access constraints; **Awerial** due to continued arrivals into Mingkaman; **Guit** due to ongoing conflict and displacement; and **Morobo, Gogrial East, the Tonj counties, Rumbek North, Twic, and Terekeka** due to escalating inter-communal violence, attacks, deteriorating road security, and new displacement.